

Active Directory Home Lab: Phase 3

Promoting DC1 to a Domain Controller

1. Open Server Manager

After logging into DC1 -

- Open **Server Manager**
- Click **Manage**
- Add Roles and Features

2. Installation Type

Select **Role-based or feature-based installation** and click **Next**

3. Server Selection

Ensure **DC1** is selected and click **Next**

4. Server Roles

- Check **Active Directory Domain Services**
- When prompted, click **Add Features**
- Click **Next** through the **Features** section

5. Install AD DS

- Review the information and click **Install**
- Wait for the installation to complete – **Do not close server manager yet**

6. Promote this server to a Domain Controller

After installation finishes, a notification flag will appear near the top-right corner.

Click the flag and select **Promote this server to a domain controller**

7. Deployment Configuration

Since this is our first domain, choose **Add a new forest**

Choosing a Domain Name

I will be using crittenden.lab because:

- .lab clearly indicates a lab environment
- This approach avoids conflicts with public domains
- This is a common practice in home labs
- .lab is more modern than “.local”

8. Domain Controller Options

- Leave **Domain Name System** checked
- Set a **Directory Services Restore** password and record it securely
- Click **Next**

The DNS delegation warning can be safely ignored in this lab.

9. NetBIOS Name

- Windows will generate one automatically
- Click **Next**

10. Database Locations

- Accept the defaults:
C:\Windows\NTDS
C:\Windows\SYSVOL
- Click **Next**

11. Review and Install

- If everything passes, click **Install**

12. Automatic Restart

The server will automatically restart. This is normal

13. Verify Success

At the login screen you should see something similar to:

CRITTENDEN\Administrator or crittenden.lab\Administrator

You now have:

- Active Directory Domain Services
- DNS
- A forest
- A domain
- Your first domain controller

Verification

- Open **Tools**

Inside Server Manager, you should see:

- Active Directory Users and Computers
- Active Directory Administrative Center
- Active Directory Domains and Trusts
- Active Directory Sites and Services
- DNS